

ABC SCHOOL
Sample Educational Institution

Admission Policy

Guidelines and Procedures for Student Enrollment

Academic Year: 2025-2026

Edition: Sample Edition

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1. Purpose and Scope

This Admission Policy outlines the principles, eligibility criteria, and procedures that govern enrollment at ABC School. It applies to all prospective students seeking admission to any grade level offered by the school, including new entrants, sibling applicants, mid-year transfers, and students with special educational needs. The policy is reviewed annually by the Admissions Committee to ensure it remains fair, transparent, and aligned with the school's educational philosophy.

The policy is intended to be read by parents and guardians considering enrollment, as well as by school staff responsible for processing applications. It should be read alongside the Fee Structure document and the Parent Handbook, which provide additional context on financial obligations and day-to-day school operations.

2. Admission Philosophy

ABC School believes that a diverse and inclusive student body strengthens the learning environment for every child. Admissions decisions are made holistically, taking into account academic readiness, age-appropriateness, available capacity, and the school's ability to support the individual needs of the applicant. The school does not guarantee admission based solely on completion of an application or payment of a registration fee; all applications are subject to review and available seats.

The Admissions Committee, composed of the Admissions Coordinator, the relevant Grade-Level Coordinator, and a member of the Senior Leadership Team, meets weekly during peak admission periods (January through April) and bi-weekly during the remainder of the academic year to review applications and make decisions.

3. Eligibility and Age Criteria

Eligibility for admission is primarily determined by the applicant's age as of the school's age cut-off date, which is set as of August 31 of the academic year of entry. Parents are encouraged to apply at least two terms in advance of the intended start date to allow sufficient time for processing, assessment, and interview scheduling.

- Applicants must meet the minimum age requirement for the grade applied to, as outlined in the age table below.
- Birth certificates or equivalent official documents are required to verify age at the time of application.
- Exceptions to age requirements are considered only in exceptional circumstances and require approval from the Principal.

4. Grade-Wise Age Requirements

The table below summarizes the minimum and maximum age (as of the August 31 cut-off) for each grade level offered at ABC School.

Grade	Minimum Age	Maximum Age	Typical Class Size
Pre-Kindergarten	3 years 0 months	4 years 0 months	16-18 students
Kindergarten	4 years 0 months	5 years 0 months	18-20 students
Grade 1	5 years 0 months	6 years 6 months	22-24 students
Grade 2	6 years 0 months	7 years 6 months	22-24 students
Grade 3	7 years 0 months	8 years 6 months	24-26 students
Grade 4	8 years 0 months	9 years 6 months	24-26 students
Grade 5	9 years 0 months	10 years 6 months	24-26 students
Grade 6	10 years 0 months	11 years 6 months	26-28 students
Grade 7	11 years 0 months	12 years 6 months	26-28 students
Grade 8	12 years 0 months	13 years 6 months	26-28 students

Applications for grades not listed above (Grade 9 and beyond) are evaluated on a case-by-case basis depending on available capacity at the secondary level.

5. Admission Process Overview

The admission process consists of five sequential stages. Each stage must be completed before the application proceeds to the next.

Stage	Description	Typical Duration
1. Inquiry	Parents submit an inquiry form and receive an information pack.	1-2 days
2. Application Submission	Completed application form and supporting documents are submitted.	Parent-dependent
3. Document Verification	Admissions office verifies submitted documents for completeness.	3-5 working days

Stage	Description	Typical Duration
4. Assessment / Interview	Age-appropriate assessment or interview is scheduled and conducted.	1-2 weeks
5. Decision and Enrollment	Outcome communicated; if successful, enrollment fee and forms are completed.	5-7 working days

6. Required Documentation

All applications must be accompanied by the following documents. Incomplete applications will not be processed until all required documents are received.

- Completed Admission Application Form, signed by both parents/guardians where applicable.
- Copy of the applicant's birth certificate or equivalent legal proof of age.
- Two recent passport-sized photographs of the applicant.
- Copy of immunization or vaccination record, as applicable to the applicant's age.
- Transfer Certificate and most recent two years of academic report cards (for applicants transferring from another school, Grade 1 and above).
- Proof of guardianship or custody documentation, where the applicant does not reside with both biological parents.
- Completed Health and Emergency Information Form.

All documents must be submitted in copy form at the time of application; original documents are verified in person at the time of enrollment confirmation and returned immediately after verification.

7. Entrance Assessment Guidelines

Entrance assessments are designed to understand the applicant's developmental stage and academic readiness rather than to rank or exclude candidates. The format of the assessment varies by grade level.

Grade Band	Assessment Format	Approximate Duration	Areas Covered
Pre-K to Kindergarten	Informal play-based observation	30 minutes	Social skills, motor skills, listening
Grades 1-3	Short written and oral activity	45 minutes	Literacy, numeracy, communication
Grades 4-6	Written assessment	60 minutes	English, Mathematics, general reasoning
Grades 7-8	Written assessment and interview	90 minutes	English, Mathematics, Science, interview

8. Sibling and Staff-Child Priority

ABC School recognizes the value of keeping families together within the same school community. Priority consideration, though not automatic admission, is extended to the following categories, subject to seat availability and the applicant meeting baseline eligibility criteria:

- Siblings of currently enrolled students, provided the sibling's application is submitted before the published priority deadline.
- Children of current ABC School staff members, in accordance with the staff benefits framework.
- Children of alumni, considered as a secondary priority category after siblings and staff children.

Priority status does not exempt an applicant from completing the assessment stage; it affects only the order in which applications are reviewed when multiple qualified candidates compete for limited seats.

9. Mid-Year and Transfer Admissions

Mid-year admissions are accepted when seats are available and the applicant's prior academic record indicates readiness to integrate into the receiving grade without significant learning gaps. Transfer applicants are required to submit academic records from their previous school covering at least the two most recently completed terms.

Where curriculum differences exist between the applicant's previous school and ABC School, a brief diagnostic check-in may be conducted during the first two weeks of enrollment to identify any additional academic support needs. This is a supportive measure and not a condition of admission.

10. Special Educational Needs Admissions

ABC School welcomes applications from students with identified special educational needs and is committed to evaluating each application on the basis of the school's capacity to provide appropriate support. Parents are asked to disclose any diagnosed learning, physical, or developmental needs at the time of application so that the Learning Support Coordinator can be involved in the assessment process.

Where the school's current resources are not sufficient to meet a student's documented support needs, the Admissions Committee will discuss this openly with the family and, where possible, suggest a reasonable alternative timeline or additional support arrangement.

11. Waitlist Policy

When a grade level reaches full capacity, qualified applicants are placed on a waitlist in the order their applications were completed and assessed. Waitlist status is valid for one academic year and must be renewed if the applicant is not offered a seat within that period.

- Waitlisted families are notified by the Admissions Office as soon as a seat becomes available.
- Families have five working days to confirm acceptance of an offered seat before it is extended to the next applicant.
- Waitlist position is not transferable between grade levels or academic years.

12. Withdrawal of Application

Applicants or their parents may withdraw an application at any stage prior to enrollment confirmation by submitting a written withdrawal request to the Admissions Office. Any application or assessment fees paid are processed in accordance with the refund terms described in the Fee Structure document.

13. Non-Discrimination Statement

ABC School admits students without regard to race, ethnicity, nationality, religion, gender, or disability status, except where a specific support requirement cannot reasonably be accommodated. All applicants are evaluated using the same documented criteria described in this policy.

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Is there an application fee?

Yes. A non-refundable application processing fee is charged at the time of submission; see the Fee Structure document for current amounts.

Can we apply for more than one grade level for the same child?

No. Applications are submitted for a single, age-appropriate grade level as determined by the age cut-off table.

What happens if our child does not pass the entrance assessment?

The assessment is developmental rather than pass/fail in most grades. Where a significant gap is identified, the Admissions Committee may recommend a later start date or additional preparation.

Can international applicants apply?

Yes. International applicants follow the same process, with academic records translated into English where necessary and submitted alongside standard documentation.

How long is an offer of admission valid?

An offer of admission is valid for ten working days from the date of notification. Seats not confirmed within this window may be released to waitlisted candidates.